

ASUS and Acer to merge?

A chinese newspaper has reported that the two companies are in talks over a possible merger



iPhone 5S and 5C taken apart

iFixit has done it again and has disassembled the iPhone 5S and the iPhone 5C in its new teardown <http://dgit.in/1akr2G9>

Workshop

Quick-Tutorial

To get you started, here is a quick tutorial on how to use custom functions to convert Rupees to Dollars using real-time conversion rates.

Method-1 [Using the inbuilt Spreadsheet Functions]

1. Create a new Spreadsheet via Google Drive.
2. Give the Spreadsheet a name.
3. Call the inbuilt currency exchange rate function using the syntax '=GoogleFinance("CURRENCY:INRUSD")' This gives the current exchange rate.
4. Use the value generated and multiply it with the Rupee value that needs to be converted as =cell_id1*cell_id2 cell_id1 will be the id of the cell where the query to GoogleFinance() is made and cell_id2 will be the id of the cell where the Rupee value to be converted is inserted.
5. Your basic currency converter is ready.
However, the results by this method are not always correct.

Method-2 [Using the script editor]

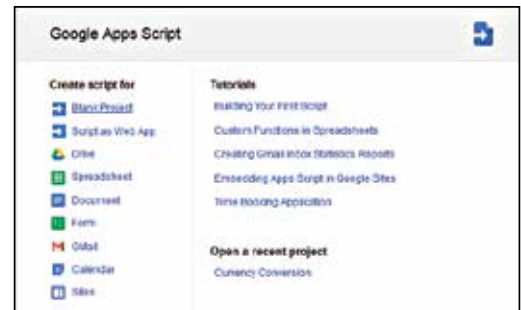
1. Create a new Spreadsheet via Google Docs and give it a name.
2. Go to Tools -> Script Editor
3. Select Blank Project. A text editor with a file called Code.gs will open.
4. Since the Google Finance API at <https://developers.google.com/finance/> is deprecated. Our first job is to find the source for the real-time conversion rates.
5. Go to www.openexchangerates.org and create a free account at <https://openexchangerates.org/signup/free> to proceed further. The documentation of this API can be found at <https://openexchangerates.org/documentation>. This is the only open-source API available and allows 1000 hits per month.
6. You will receive your app id at the e-mail you provide.
7. Paste in the following code in Code.gs
function currencyConversion() //
function name
//useful with multiple functions in
Script manager
{var source = UrlFetchApp.
fetch("http://openexchangerates.
org/latest.json?app_id=3765c31e473

```
94295bafda5xxxxxxxxx" );  
//Insert the app id you received in  
your mail  
var sheet = SpreadsheetApp.  
openById ( '0AsH148OVr7dldEhBdm  
9qQWg3dEdiYjM3xxxxxxxxx' );  
//The Spreadsheet id can be found in  
the URL between '?' and '#'
```

```
var obj = Utilities.  
jsonParse (source.getContent-  
Text ( ) );  
//getContentText() returns json-type  
data that is parsed using Utilities class  
var value = sheet.  
getRange ( "B1" ).getValue ( ) ;  
//getRange() selects cell and  
getValue() retrieves value  
var exRate = obj [ "rates" ] ;  
//The obj var has the attribute - rates  
which provides a list of keywords  
//exRate is a pointer to the
```

```
first keyword  
for (var id in exRate)  
//loops through all the keywords  
{if (id="INR")  
//Three character international code  
{sheet.getRange ( "B2" ).  
setValue (exRate[id] );  
//setValue() sets the value of the cell  
//Each keyword has a value  
sheet.getRange ( "B3" ).  
setValue (value/exRate[id] );  
//exRate array has associated values which  
have the base of USD, which means  
exRate[USD]==1 will be True.  
}}}
```

8. Save (Ctrl+S) your code and give it a name.
9. Go to Tools -> Script manager. A dialogue box will appear. Hit run.
10. A dialogue box will pop up for the Authorization of the app.
11. Hit OK and Accept the Google terms and conditions.
12. Now Run again using the Script Manager.
13. The last step is to establish a trigger to execute the app.
 1. Go to the code-editor.
 2. Resources ->Current project's triggers
 3. Add new trigger.
 4. Select the currencyConversion() for Run and for Events, set it to From Spreadsheet and On edit.



Creating a new script



The code in action

5. Similarly add another trigger for Events with From Spreadsheet - On open settings.
6. Save.
14. Your currency converter is ready.
It might take a few seconds to load.
You can also use apps published by other users by going to Tools ->Script gallery.

That's it!

Just by this simple tutorial, you can understand why scripting in Apps Script is much more convenient than regular java code in eclipse.

Apps Script can be learnt very easily, owing to the exhaustive collection of tutorials available on the internet for free. Event triggers, Database support and other extensions of Apps Script can be found at <https://developers.google.com/apps-script>. There is also a step-by-step approach given at <https://developers.google.com/apps-script/articles> and for further understanding the core concepts, the tutorials at <https://developers.google.com/apps-script/guides/sheets> are very useful. For any queries, there is a good chance you will be able to find a similar question at <http://stackoverflow.com/tags/google-apps-script>. Various other case studies are available at <https://developers.google.com/apps-script/case-studies> that interested Apps Script programmers should definitely go through. 